

CLASS - 12th

SUBJECT - ENGLISH

PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

CLASS 12TH BIHAR BOARD – ENGLISH (RAINBOW PART 2)

POETRY CHAPTER 2: SONG OF MYSELF (BY WALT WHITMAN)

CHAPTER SUMMARY (IN 50 WORDS)

"Song of Myself" is a famous democratic poem by Walt Whitman. The poet celebrates his own individuality while highlighting that every human being is interconnected. He emphasizes that all humans are born from the same soil and share the same blood, promoting universal brotherhood and love.

12 IMPORTANT SHORT SUBJECTIVE QUESTIONS & ANSWERS

Q1. What does the poet mean when he says, "I celebrate myself, and sing myself"?

Ans: The poet means that he rejoices in his own existence and individuality. At the same time, he celebrates the existence of all mankind because what he assumes, everyone else assumes.

Q2. What does the poet say about his origin and blood?

Ans: The poet says that his tongue and every atom of his blood are formed from this specific soil and air. He notes that he was born of parents born here from parents the same.

Q3. How old is the poet, and what is his current health condition?

Ans: The poet is thirty-seven years old, and he is in perfect, robust health. He hopes to continue living with the same energy until his death.

Q4. What does the poet observe or lean and loafe for in summer?

Ans: The poet leans and loafes at his ease in summer to observe a spear of summer grass, appreciating the simple beauty of nature.

Q5. What does the poet mean by "creeds and schools in abeyance"?

Ans: He means that religious beliefs, social divisions, and institutional systems should be kept aside or paused temporarily to appreciate universal human connection.

Q6. What does the poet harbor or believe in, according to the poem?

Ans: The poet harbors for good or bad. He permits himself to speak at every hazard, believing in the raw energy of nature without check.



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Q7. How does Walt Whitman establish a connection with the readers?

Ans: He establishes a connection by saying, "What I assume you shall assume," implying that all human thoughts, feelings, and atomic compositions are identical.

Q8. Why is Walt Whitman called the "People's Poet"?

Ans: He is called the people's poet because his poetry breaks traditional rules, praises the common man, democracy, and celebrates free human spirit.

Q9. What does the poem teach us about human equality?

Ans: The poem teaches us that all humans are equal because everyone is made of the same atoms, breathes the same air, and belongs to the same earth.

Q10. What is "Original Energy" mentioned at the end of the poem?

Ans: Original energy refers to the wild, unchecked, and pure power of nature that exists in its primal form, free from human modifications.

Q11. What is the significance of the "spear of summer grass"?

Ans: It is a visual anchor representing that even the smallest, most common element of nature holds immense beauty and deserves celebration.

Q12. What is the central theme of "Song of Myself"?

Ans: The central theme is the celebration of self, unity of mankind, the beauty of nature, and universal brotherhood across all boundaries.

35 OBJECTIVE QUESTIONS (QUESTION & OPTIONS IN SINGLE LINE)

- 'Song of Myself' is composed by the famous poet: (A) John Donne (B) Walt Whitman (C) W.H. Auden (D) Rupert Brooke
- Walt Whitman is popularly known as the: (A) Romantic Poet (B) People's Poet (C) War Poet (D) Nature Poet
- Walt Whitman was an _____ poet, essayist, and journalist.: (A) American (B) British (C) Indian (D) Irish
- Walt Whitman was born in the year 1819 and died in: (A) 1948 (B) 1892 (C) 1915 (D) 1965
- Whitman worked as a carpenter, printer, teacher, editor, and volunteered as a _____ during the Civil War.: (A) soldier (B) nurse / caregiver (C) lawyer (D) politician
- Whitman's famous collection of poetry is titled: (A) Leaves of Grass (B) Drum-Taps (C) Songs and Sonnets (D) Lyrical Ballads
- The poem 'Song of Myself' is written in: (A) rhyming verse (B) free verse (C) sonnet form (D) blank verse



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8. "I celebrate myself, and _____ myself.": (A) hate (B) sing (C) isolate (D) destroy
9. "And what I assume you shall _____ .": (A) reject (B) assume (C) complain (D) forget
10. The poet says that every _____ of his blood belongs to the reader as well.: (A) drop (B) atom (C) part (D) cell
11. The poet is presently _____ years old.: (A) twenty-five (B) thirty-five (C) thirty-seven (D) forty
12. The poet is in perfect _____ health.: (A) weak (B) robust / good (C) critical (D) mental
13. The poet hopes to cease not until: (A) marriage (B) death (C) graduation (D) morning
14. "Creeds and schools in _____ .": (A) progress (B) abeyance (C) demand (D) action
15. The poet invites his _____ to loafe with him.: (A) friends (B) soul (C) enemies (D) parents
16. The poet loafes at his ease observing a spear of summer: (A) flower (B) grass (C) leaf (D) tree
17. The poet says his tongue and blood are formed from this: (A) machine (B) soil and air (C) water only (D) gold
18. The parents of the poet were born from parents: (A) different (B) the same (C) foreign (D) unknown
19. "I harbor for good or _____ .": (A) best (B) bad (C) great (D) none
20. The poet permits himself to speak at every: (A) function (B) hazard / danger (C) meeting (D) classroom
21. The poem celebrates the concept of universal: (A) war (B) brotherhood / democracy (C) business (D) isolation
22. Walt Whitman's poetry collection 'Leaves of Grass' was published at his own: (A) school (B) expense / cost (C) country's wish (D) friend's press
23. The expression "nature without check" implies nature in its: (A) modified form (B) original / raw energy (C) beautiful garden (D) dangerous state
24. In the poem, the poet reflects a deeply _____ outlook.: (A) narrow (B) democratic and humanitarian (C) superstitious (D) angry
25. The poem suggests that all human beings are physically and spiritually: (A) separate (B) interconnected / equal (C) enemies (D) different
26. "Song of Myself" highlights that nature does not make any: (A) laws (B) discrimination / distinctions (C) sounds (D) trees
27. Whitman's work was initially rejected in America because of its unconventional: (A) language (B) style and free form (C) price (D) size
28. The poet loafes in which season?: (A) Winter (B) Summer (C) Monsoon (D) Spring
29. "Hoping to cease not till death" shows the poet's optimism for: (A) business (B) life and health (C) poems (D) travels
30. The tone of the poem is highly celebratory and: (A) sorrowful (B) energetic / joyful (C) scary (D)



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31. The word 'Loafe' means to wander or spend time: (A) quickly (B) idly / at ease (C) angrily (D) productively
32. Whitman gained massive popularity in Europe, especially after appreciation from: (A) Gandhi (B) Emerson (C) Shakespeare (D) Keats
33. The atom mentioned in the poem represents the smallest unit of human: (A) mind (B) physical existence (C) money (D) cloth
34. Whitman's poetry collection 'Drum-Taps' was inspired by his experiences in the American: (A) University (B) Civil War (C) Agriculture (D) Parliament
35. "Song of Myself" is an essential masterpiece of 19th-century _____ literature.: (A) British (B) American (C) Indian (D) French



SUJIT KUMAR

